



GAME RULES

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PART 8: THE GAME SEQUENCE

OGÓLNE



8.1 ROUNDS AND PHASES



A game lasts up to **5 Rounds**. Each Round has four Phases resolved in strict order:

Phase	Name	Key Actions
1	The Movement Phase	Deploy , Move , Disengage , Hold
2	The Assault Phase	Ranged Attack , Charge , Run, Hold
3	The Combat Phase	Close Ranks, Close Combat Attack
4	The Scoring & Cleanup Phase	Control Markers , Score VP, Cleanup

<< VISUAL: Round sequence flowchart >>

8.2 THE ACTIVATION SYSTEM



During Phases 1, 2 and 3, players use **Alternating Activation**. The holder of the [First Player Marker](#) decides which player activates first each Phase. Players then alternate, each activating one Unit per turn. Each **Activated** Unit performs exactly **one** action from the list available in that Phase.

8.2.1 Passing and Initiative



At any point during a turn, the Active Player may **Pass** instead of activating a Unit. A player must **Pass** if they have no eligible Units left.

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The first player to **Pass** in a Phase takes the First Player Marker for the next Phase. Once a player **Passes**, they cannot activate any further Units this Phase. The opponent then completes their remaining activations.

8.2.2 Determining the First Player



Players Roll-Off (Part 3.2). The winner assigns the First Player Marker to either player for Round 1.

DESIGNER'S NOTE: The Roll-Off winner can give the First Player Marker to their opponent - and this can sometimes be the right call. Going second in the Movement Phase means your opponent commits their Units first, allowing you to react. Going first in the Assault Phase rewards you for Passing early in Movement. Deciding who starts Round 1 with that Marker is itself a strategic decision, not just a formality.

8.3 DEPLOYMENT AND RESERVES



No Units begin on the battlefield. All Units included in the **Army List** start in Reserves. Bring them onto the battlefield during the Movement Phase as Supply allows.

DESIGNER'S NOTE: Starting each Unit in Reserve is a deliberate departure from traditional miniature wargaming. Instead of deploying the whole army on the table at the start and committing to those positions before rolling a single die, players develop their battlefield presence gradually through each Round. This approach is similar to how a traditional real-time strategy game develops its economic presence - early Rounds require decisions on which Units to commit with limited Supply, while later Rounds punish those who didn't manage these early decisions effectively. It also helps to eliminate the common problem of alpha-striking on Turn 1.

8.3.1 The Supply Pool



Reinforcements do not arrive all at once; Warp conduits take time to stabilise, Overlords require flight corridors, and Dropships queue on orbital approach vectors.

The **Supply Pool** is the total available capacity that any commander may have at any instant, and this increases as logistics close the gap on the frontline.

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- **Round 1:** **Supply Pool** equals the **Mission Card's** starting Supply.
- **Later Rounds:** **Supply Pool** increases by the **Supply Escalation** value each Round.
- **Final Round:** In the last Round of every game (as defined by the **Mission Card**), the **Supply Pool** becomes unlimited. All remaining Units in Reserves may be deployed without Supply restrictions, following the normal alternating activation sequence.
- **Hard Cap:** **Total Current Supply** of on-table Units may **never** exceed the **Supply Pool**.

8.3.2 Available Supply

A commander's resources are only so plentiful. Every squad draws from the same pool of ammunition, bandwidth, and command focus. The resources you've committed so far will determine what remains available. Managing the gap between what's been committed and what's still accessible is what distinguishes a measured escalation from an army peaking too early.

Available Supply equals the **Current Supply Pool** minus the **Total Supply of Friendly Units** on the Battlefield.

A Unit can only be fielded if its **Current Supply Value** is less than or equal to the Available Supply. Units Destroyed in battle (or reduced by casualties) free up Available Supply for new arrivals.

8.3.3 Deployment Restrictions

When a Unit arrives from Reserves, that Unit cannot end its arrival during that Activation inside the opponent's Zone of Influence. This restriction applies to all forms of arrival, whether the Unit enters from an edge, arrives via a Warp Prism, or is summoned. Additionally, a Unit can never end a Deploy action Out of Coherency. If all models cannot be placed legally while maintaining **Coherency**, the Unit cannot be deployed in that location.

Abathur's TIP: When you begin, resources will be limited, and the board will still be taking shape. If you deploy a high-value Unit too early, it will be vulnerable to heavy fire before you have enough board presence to

support it. On the other hand, holding Units in Reserve for too long will waste their potential. A good strategy is to start by deploying cheap Units to contest Markers and gather information, then deploy your high-Units in Rounds 2 and 3.

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8.4 PHASE 1: THE MOVEMENT PHASE

The ground is constantly shifting even before the first shot is fired. Teams dig in, reinforcements pour in from above, and exhausted Units fall back to regroup. During the Movement Phase, the battlefield terrain changes as a command decides where the battles will be fought.

At the start of the Movement Phase:

- Resolve all "Start of the Round" abilities. The first player resolves their first if both players have effects.

If a player has multiple "Start of the Round" effects to resolve, that player chooses the order in which their effects resolve. Each effect is fully resolved before the next begins.

- Verify Available Supply for all players.

8.4.1 Activations

Orders are issued one at a time. A squad moves, a position is taken, and the Enemy reacts. Every activation is a commitment.

On the Active Player's turn, choose one:

- **Activate a Unit on the battlefield without an Activation Marker** - perform a Move, Hold or Disengage action.
- **Activate a Unit in Reserves without an Activation Marker** - perform a Deploy action to enter the battlefield.

After the action, set an **Activation Marker (Movement side)** next to the Unit.

8.4.2 Passing

The first player to **Pass** takes the First Player Marker for Phase 2. Set **Activation Markers** (Movement side) next to any Friendly on-table Units that

did not activate.

Abathur's TIP: Making a **Pass** early in the Movement Phase is a game **move**. The first player to make a **Pass** gains the **First Player Marker** in the Assault Phase and gets to shoot first. If you have already set up your key **Units** or have nothing left to **deploy**, make a **Pass** immediately. This allows you to gain perfect information as your opponent uses their **activations**, while you observe. However, moving too early means missing opportunities to manoeuvre, so it's a constant balancing act between the benefits of information and maintaining flexibility.

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8.5 MOVEMENT PHASE ACTIONS

8.5.1 Hold

The Unit performs no action. Set an Activation Marker beside it.

The Unit counts as Activated for the current Phase.

8.5.2 Move

An **Unengaged** Unit changes its position on the battlefield.

8.5.3 Resolving a Move

When a rule instructs a Unit to **Move**, **Run**, or otherwise reposition using standard movement, resolve it as follows:

STEP 1 - **THE LEADING MODEL**

- Choose a **Leading Model** and **move** it up to the Unit's **Speed** (see Part **5.1** for split **Speed** values). Measure the actual path travelled.
- The **Leading Model** may pass through **Friendly models** in its own Unit.
- The **Leading Model** may **not** pass through **Enemy models** or **Friendly models** from other **Units**. **Ground models** may pass through a **Flying** model's base as if it were not there, and vice versa.
- The **Leading Model** cannot **move** through terrain of **Size 2** or larger.

- Follow **Gap Clearance** rules (Part [4.6](#)).

- The [Leading Model](#) cannot change elevation unless it passes through an [ACCESS POINT](#).

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- The [Leading Model](#) may **not** end overlapping terrain or another model's base.

- The [Leading Model's](#) entire base must end on the battlefield.

- The [Leading Model](#) cannot end [Within 1"](#) ([Engagement Range](#)) of an [Enemy Ground Unit](#).

- No part of a base of the [Leading Model](#) can [move](#) more than its unit **Speed** value.

STEP 2 - OTHER [MODELS](#)

- Pick up all remaining [models](#) and set them **In Coherency** (Part [4.4](#)) around the [Leading Model](#).

- These [models](#) are set, not moved - they may ignore intervening obstacles. However, they **must** end in a legal position: no overlapping [bases](#), entire [bases](#) on the battlefield, and not [Within 1"](#) of an [Enemy Unit](#).

<< VISUAL: Leading Model moves to new position; squad set within 3" Coherency around it >>

TERRAIN INTERACTIONS

- **Size 0 & Size 1:** Pass through freely. **Cannot** end movement overlapping the terrain's footprint.

- [Grass](#) (Size 2 - special case): Refer to the [GRASS](#) keyword (Part 11) for the full rules. [Grass](#) does not block movement but does block [Line of Sight](#), following the standard [Cover](#) rules (Part [7.1.1](#)). If the [Leading Model's](#) path of travel passes through or any model of a Unit ends on a [Grass](#) terrain piece, that [Grass](#) piece is immediately removed from the game for the remainder of the battle.

- [Flying Units](#): A [Flying](#) Unit moving over [Grass](#) does not destroy the [Grass](#) terrain piece. [Flying models](#) pass above the terrain, not through it. If any model of a [Flying](#) Unit ends on a [Grass](#) terrain piece, it is removed as normal.

- **Size 2 and larger:** Cannot [move](#) through.

ELEVATION

[Models](#) can stand one of three elevations:

- GROUND LEVEL: Standing directly on the playmat.
- MID GROUND: Standing on horizontal terrain of **Size 1** or **2**.
- HIGH GROUND: Standing on horizontal terrain of **Size 3** or larger.

The model stands on Elevation if its base is at that elevation. If the model's base is on multiple elevation levels, assume it is standing on the highest of those elevations.

ACCESS POINTS connect different elevation levels. Models change elevation only by moving through an ACCESS POINT (examples: ladders, portals, doors).

RAMPS are **Size 1** MID GROUND terrain. A model on a ramp at any point along its surface is at MID GROUND elevation. Models cannot pass through a ramp freely - they may only enter and exit through the ramp's two **ACCESS POINTS** (one at the base, one at the top) and may end their movement on the ramp.

<< **VISUAL: Marine moving from GROUND LEVEL through ACCESS POINT to RAMP, then through second ACCESS POINT to HIGH GROUND** >>

FLYING MOVE

Units with the Flying Combat Tag ignore all normal movement restrictions. The Leading Model moves point-to-point, ignoring all terrain and models between the start and end. Other models may pass through a Flying model's base as if it were not there.

Flying Units and Engagement Range:

- A Flying Unit may end its movement in **Base-to-Base** contact with Ground Units and vice versa - Flying models are **never Engaged**, and this proximity has no effect on either Unit's ability to act.
- Flying models are never Engaged (Part **7.2.1**). A Flying Unit **must** end its movement at least **1"** away from all Enemy Flying Units.

8.5.4 Disengage

The most challenging manoeuvre a squad will ever make is to pull back under heavy fire. Losing the initiative on a pinned position demands calm discipline, swift action, and enough firepower to keep the pursuers at bay.

An Engaged Unit withdraws from melee.

- Move it following the standard Move rules (Part **8.5.3**).

- Any individual model that cannot end its movement strictly outside the Engagement Range of all Enemy Units is immediately removed and considered Destroyed. Other models in the Unit that successfully clear the Engagement Range remain unaffected - the Unit continues with its remaining models.

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- If the Leading Model itself cannot end its movement outside the Engagement Range of all Enemy Units, the Disengage fails. The Unit does not move, the Leading Model is removed, and the Unit's activation ends.

- A Unit that Disengages cannot perform Ranged Attack or Charge in the following Assault Phase - unless its Current Supply Value is greater than the Combined Supply of all enemies it was Engaged with.

DESIGNER'S NOTE: The Tactical Mass exception to the Disengage penalty prevents small screening Units from holding up a much larger and more valuable force indefinitely. It should not be possible for a small group of Zerglings to hold up a Siege Tank locked in melee indefinitely. When the disengaging Unit has significantly more mass than its opponent, it has the mass to Disengage and still operate at full effectiveness. This creates a paradox: Units that slow down the Enemy have limited ability to stop them completely.

8.5.5 Deploy

The moment boots hit the ground, there is no going back. Timing a deployment correctly can swing an entire flank. Timing it wrong feeds reinforcements into a meat grinder.

A Unit from Reserves enters the battlefield.

- Confirm the Unit's Current Supply Value fits within the Available Supply.

- Set the Leading Model in contact with the player's Entry Edge outside of the battlefield, then move it up to the Unit's Speed following standard Move rules (Part 8.5.3).

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- Treat the Entry Edge as a base of a Leading Model, then move it up to the unit's speed following standard Move rules (Part 8.5.3).

- The Leading Model enters first. Set the rest of the Unit In Coherency.

- The Unit cannot finish its activation within the enemy's Zone of Influence.

- Unit can never end a Deploy action Out of Coherency. If all models cannot be placed legally while maintaining Coherency, the Unit cannot be deployed

in that location.

UNITS RETURNED TO RESERVES

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Some rules will remove the Unit from the battlefield and return it to the Reserves. The Unit is not Destroyed; it has left the battlefield. When the Unit is returned to the Reserves, the **Current Supply** used by the Unit is released, and the Available Supply is recalculated from that moment onwards.

The Unit keeps all the equipment it had when it left the battlefield. The **Damage** recorded by the **Damage Marker** that the Unit suffered before it was removed remains with the Unit. When the Unit is redeployed, it will carry the same **Damage**.

Any buffs, debuffs, or mission effects with a set duration "until the **End of the Round**" and similar effects stay on the Unit. However, the clock does not pause just because the Unit has left. If an effect were to expire during Cleanup & Refresh (Part 8.9.5), it still would, whether the Unit is on the table or not.

While in Reserves, the Unit keeps all its **Active**, **Passive**, and Reaction Abilities, but none of them function. They cannot be triggered, they produce no effects, and they cannot be used to pay costs or respond to events. They are on the card, not on the battlefield. When the Unit redeploys, all its abilities resume immediately unless an ability explicitly states otherwise.

However, the Tokens and Markers that the Unit left behind on the battlefield will be removed, unless they have the STAY IN PLAY keyword.

If the Unit was **Activated** during the current Phase, once it is returned to the Reserves, it will remain **Activated** and will not be able to take further action within the current Phase.

Visual Example - placeholder

8.6 PHASE 2: THE ASSAULT PHASE



It is here that the line finally breaks. Gauss Rifle fire cracks along the fire lanes, siege shells soar over the barricades, and Zealots charge the last metres in a last-ditch push. The Assault Phase is when the **Damage** is done, **Ranged Attacks** tear through exposed Units, and **Charges** strike defenders who chose a poor position.

8.6.1 Activations



On the Active Player's turn, activate a Unit with an **Activation Marker** (Movement side) and select one action: Run, Hold, Charge, or Ranged Attack. After completing the action, set an **Activation Marker** (Assault side) next to it. Units still in Reserves cannot act during this Phase.

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8.6.2 Passing



The first player to **Pass** takes the First Player Marker for Phase 3. Set **Activation Markers** (Assault side) next to any Units that did not activate.

8.7 ASSAULT PHASE ACTIONS



8.7.1 Run



Sometimes the best use of a Unit's activation is not to fight at all. A squad repositioning to claim a Marker next Round, a flanking force closing the gap before a decisive Charge, or a screening Unit pulling back from an exposed position are all valid reasons to give up an entire Assault Phase activation without firing a shot.

An Unengaged Unit moves across the battlefield following the standard Move rules (Part 8.5.3). The procedure is identical to a Movement Phase Move:

Nominate a Leading Model, move it up to the Unit's **Speed**, and set remaining models **In Coherency**. All standard restrictions apply, including Gap Clearance (Part 4.6) and the prohibition on ending Within the Engagement Range of Enemy Units.

Abathur's TIP: Running in the Assault Phase is one of the most underused tools available to a new player. If your Unit cannot reach a worthwhile target with a Ranged Attack or Charge, do not waste the activation on a Hold. Use the Run to close the distance for the next Round, reposition onto a **Mission Marker**, or pull back behind Cover before the Enemy can respond. Two Moves across two Phases (a Move in Phase 1 followed by a Run in Phase 2) will cover twice the ground of a single Move, and that extra distance can be the difference between contesting an objective and watching your opponent score it unopposed.

8.7.2 Hold

The Unit does not take any action. Set an **Activation Marker** (Assa

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8.7.3 Ranged Attack

Fire is the language of the Assault Phase. A volley of Gauss Rifle rounds tears through a Unit caught crossing open ground. A Hydralisk spine salvo pins down an advancing squad behind a wall. A single Siege Tank shell lands among a cluster of infantry and scatters them. Every ranged weapon on the battlefield has the potential to reshape the fight before the enemy can close the distance, but only if the shot is aimed at the right target, at the right time, with the right weapon.

A Ranged Attack is resolved in two stages. First, the attacking player selects a valid target and assigns weapons to it. Second, the attack is resolved through the three-pool system: dice move from the Attack Pool through the Armour Pool to the Damage Pool, with each stage giving both sides a chance to influence the outcome. Units with multiple weapon profiles may split their fire across different targets, resolving each weapon as a separate Batch.

1. TARGET ELIGIBILITY

A valid target **must** meet all of the following criteria:

- At least one Visible models from the target Unit isare Within the weapon's maximum **Range**. Measure from the attacking model's base to the target model's base.
- Only models Within Range to at least one and Visible model from the target Unit contribute dice to the Attack Roll.
- The target's **Combat Tag** matches the weapon's target characteristic (Ground, Flying or All).
- **Engagement Status**: An Unengaged attacking Unit cannot select an Engaged Unit as a target (except Spillover from Template Weapons - see Part 8.7.6). An Engaged attacking Unit may only target the Unit(s) it is currently Engaged with.

2. WEAPON SELECTION AND BATCHING

Each model fires one of its available Assault Phase weapons. All models using the same **Weapon Profile** must fire at the same target - the player cannot split a single profile's fire. A Batch consists of all models firing the same weapon at the same target. This same-profile, same-target rule

applies to **SIDEARM** weapons as well - all **models** firing the same **SIDEARM** profile must target the same Unit, although that Unit may differ from the target of the Unit's other weapons.

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If a Unit has multiple Weapon Profiles, it may fire at different targets - resolved in separate Batches.

REMOVING DICE: When a **Special Ability** reduces the number of **dice within** a Batch, the player controlling the Unit resolving that ability chooses which **dice** are removed.

Abathur's TIP: Batch sequencing provides a slight advantage. By declaring and resolving each Batch individually, you can use the first Batch to weaken or eliminate your target, then modify the second Batch depending on the result. If your Unit has two weapon profiles, use the one more likely to eliminate your **Damaged Enemy** first. If that works out, your second profile can be used to engage a new **enemy**. Remember that if your **models** have the same weapon, they must fire at the same target. When building your army, **Units** with single powerful weapon profiles are more **Damage**-focused but less flexible, while **Units** with multiple profile **Damage** are more flexible with multiple targets.

BATCH SEQUENCE: Declare the target of one Batch, resolve it fully, and then declare the next Batch. The player does not declare all targets simultaneously.

DESIGNER'S NOTE: If a Batch Destroys the **Enemy** Unit your **Friendly** Unit was **Engaged** with, that **Friendly** Unit immediately becomes **Unengaged** (unless still **Engaged** with another **enemy**). Remaining Batches may target freely.

8.7.4 Ranged Attack Resolution



Every attack is resolved by moving **dice** through three pools. **Dice** begin in the Attack Pool, pass through the **Armour Pool**, and end in the **Damage Pool**. **Dice** that survive the entire sequence inflict casualties.

Attack Pool. Generate a number of **dice** equal to each attacking model's **Rate of Attack (RoA)**. Roll all **dice** in this pool against the weapon's **Hit** characteristic. Each die that meets or exceeds the **Hit** value is a success. **Move** it to the **Armour Pool**. Discard all failures.

Armour Pool. The defender rolls all **dice** in this pool against the target Unit's **Armour** characteristic. Each die that meets or exceeds the **Armour** value is a success. Discard it. **Move** all failures to the **Damage Pool**. Some effects bypass this roll entirely: **dice** moved out of the **Armour Pool** by Surge or **CRITICAL HIT** are set directly into the **Damage Pool** without an **Armour Roll**.

Damage Pool. Each die remaining in this pool inflicts **Damage** equal to the weapon's **Damage** characteristic. If the target Unit is eligible for an **Evade Roll**, the defender rolls all dice in this pool against the Unit's characteristic before **Damage** is applied. Each die that meets or exceeds the **Evade** value is a success and is discarded. Remaining dice inflict **Damage** as normal.

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Resolve each Batch in sequence:

1. ROLL TO HIT

- For each attacking model with an eligible target, add dice equal to the weapon's **RoA** to the Attack Pool.
- If the weapon has an **S Dice** characteristic, add one **Surge Die** (use a different colour). If there is no **S Dice**, the Surge Result is 0.
- Roll all Attack Dice. Results equal to or higher than the weapon's **Hit** value are successes. Move successful dice to the **Armour Pool**.

DESIGNER'S NOTE: If dice in the same Batch have different modifiers, roll them separately. It still counts as the same Batch.

2. RESOLVE SURGE

- Check if the target Unit's **Combat Tag** matches the weapon's **Surge Type**. If not, the **Surge Die** result is ignored entirely - discard it. No dice move from the **Armour Pool** at this step.
- If it matches, move a number of dice equal to the **Surge Die result** from the **Armour Pool** directly to the **Damage Pool**. These bypass **Armour** entirely. Surge can **never** move more dice than are currently in the **Armour Pool**.

Abathur's TIP: Surge stands out as one of the most efficient sources of **Damage** because **Surge Dice** bypasses the entire Armour rolling process. Before firing off any Rounds, always check that the **Surge Type** of your chosen weapon aligns with the target's Combat Tag. Using Anti-Ground Surge on a **Ground** target can double or triple your **Damage** output compared to firing at a Flying target with the same weapon. When building your army, be sure to select weapons with **Surge Types** that match the Combat Tags you are most likely to encounter.

3. ARMOUR ROLLS

- The defender rolls all dice in the **Armour Pool**.
- Results equal to or higher than the Unit's **Armour** characteristic: **success** - discard the die.
- Results lower than Armour: **failure** - move the die to the **Damage Pool**.

4. EVADE ROLLS

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Perform this step only if the target Unit qualifies:

- A Special Ability or keyword grants an **Evade Roll**.
- The target is Engaged and is suffering **Damage** from a Ranged Attack.

If eligible, the defender rolls all dice in the **Damage Pool**. Results equal to or higher than the Unit's **Evade** characteristic: **success** - remove those dice. Remaining dice are confirmed **Damage**.

5. RESOLVE DAMAGE AND CASUALTIES

If there are no dice left in the **Damage Pool**, ignore this phase.

- Multiply the remaining dice in the **Damage Pool** by the weapon's **Damage** characteristic.
- Add any previously accumulated **Damage** (from earlier attacks in this or previous Rounds), indicated by a **Damage Marker**. This total is the **Total Damage**.
- Apply any Special Skills that reduce the Total **Damage**.
- Remove casualties model by model. The defending player removes models from the target Unit, following these rules:
 - The attack **cannot** remove more models than the number of Visible models in the target Unit.
 - While Total **Damage** equals or exceeds a model's HP, remove one Visible model and reduce Total **Damage** by that model's HP. Repeat.
 - If all Visible models are Destroyed, discard remaining Total **Damage** - it does not carry over to non-Visible models.
 - If Total **Damage** remains but **cannot** Destroy the next Visible model, record it with a **Damage Marker** (e.g. a D6 set next to the Unit).

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8.7.5 Removing Models from Engaged Units



When the target Unit is Engaged, ignore standard Visibility rules.

Whenever an Engaged Unit suffers casualties from any source, ignore standard Visibility rules and apply the following priority order instead.

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The defending player **must** remove casualties in this strict priority order:

Priority 1: Models not Within the Engagement Range of any Enemy Unit.

Priority 2: Models Within the Engagement Range but not in **Base-to-Base** contact.

Priority 3: Models in **Base-to-Base** contact with an Enemy model.

When selecting a model to remove at Priority 2 or 3, the defending player **cannot** choose a model if removing it would cause the Unit to stop being Engaged with a specific Enemy Unit - provided there is another valid casualty in any priority tier.

<< **VISUAL:** Four Zealots Engaged with a Queen and a Hydralisk. Three Zealots (A) in base contact with Queen; one Zealot (B) Within 1" of Hydralisk. Priority shown: two A models first (Priority 3), then the player chooses the final A or B >>

*In this example, Miniature B **cannot** be removed first (Priority 2) because doing so would break the Zealot Unit's Engagement with the Hydralisk. Once only one valid casualty remains, the controlling player may choose either the last A or B.*

DESIGNER'S NOTE: The Engaged casualty priority system prevents the defending player from picking off models to escape Engagements they would rather not be in. Otherwise, an opponent could absorb **Damage** from shooting by taking the single model that is holding them in a difficult melee combat, effectively giving their Enemy a free Disengage action. The priority makes shooting at a melee force eat away at the outer models first, protecting the core of the melee until the Engaged models are removed.

8.7.6 Template Weapons

BLAST TEMPLATE (BT) / FLAMER TEMPLATE (FT)

1. ALIGNMENT

- **BT:** The template **must** cover as much of the target model's base as possible. The centre of the target model's base is the **Target Point**.

- **FT:** The narrow end must be flush with the attacking model's base edge and aimed at the target. The centre of the target model's base is the **Target Point**.

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- Templates affect only models at the same elevation level as the **Target Point**.

Flying models are not on any elevation level for template purposes. A template set at GROUND LEVEL does not affect Flying models, and a template cannot be set on a Flying model's elevation level, unless the template weapon has Target: ALL or Target: Flying.

Abathur's TIP: Template weapons need careful placement. A well-timed Blast Template can hit two or three Units at once, causing spillover Batches in addition to the main **Damage**. Pay attention to turns when the Enemy has a "bunch" of Units around the same terrain piece or **Mission Marker**. Flamer Templates have a shorter range but almost always hit everything Within the cone, making them very effective against tightly packed melee Units. When facing armies that heavily rely on Templates, keep your Units at maximum **Coherency** and avoid having too many Units on a single objective.

2. DECLARING TARGETS

Follow standard Target Eligibility (Part 8.7.3) with this exception: select one Enemy Unit as the Primary target - all models in that Unit covered by the template are the Main target. Every other model (Friendly or Enemy) covered by the template is resolved under Spillover, provided they share the same elevation and Combat Tag as the Primary target.

3. DETERMINING HITS

A model is affected if all of the following are true:

- Its base is partially or fully covered by the template.
- It is on the same elevation as the declared **Target Point**.
- A line traced from the **target model's base** (BT) or **Attacking Model's base** (FT) to the model's base is not blocked by terrain piece (**Size 2+**).
- It is an eligible target type (e.g., a **Ground-only** template does not affect Flying models, even if it is covered).

4. ATTACK POOL GENERATION

- **Main Target:** Generate a number of Attack Dice equal to the number of Affected models in the target Unit, plus any weapon Rate of Attack modifiers.
- Spillover (separate Batches per Unit): Generate a number of Attack Dice

equal to the number of Affected models in that Unit only. Do not apply Rate of Attack modifiers. Do not apply Surge.

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5. RESOLUTION

- Roll to Hit as normal. Roll the generated Attack Dice for the Batch. Any result equal to or higher than the weapon's Hit characteristic is a success and is moved to the **Armour Pool**.

- Do not roll a **Surge Die**. For the Main target, the Surge Result equals the number of Affected models in that Unit. Spillover attacks do not generate Surge.

- Apply Surge efficiency normally for the Main target if the **Combat Tag** matches. Do not apply Surge to Spillover.

VISUAL EXAMPLE placeholder

8.7.7 Charge

The last few metres are the longest. A charging squad crosses open ground with nothing between them and the Enemy but speed, aggression, and the hope that the dice fall right.

An Unengaged Ground Unit moves into the Engagement Range of Enemy Units.

1. DECLARE TARGETS

- All targets **must** possess the **Ground Combat Tag**. Flying Units cannot Charge or be **Charged**.

- A Charge does **not** require Line of Sight.

- Declare **all** intended targets before rolling.

DESIGNER'S NOTE: **Charges** do not require a Line of Sight. This is because melee combatants are assumed to be able to detect threats through sound, vibration, and general battlefield awareness. **Charges** would require a Line of Sight if they didn't, and attacking an opponent behind a wall or barricade would be impossible. This would make melee Units impossible to play in a map-heavy game.

2. DETERMINE CHARGE DISTANCE

- Choose the Leading Model and nominate one model per target Unit as the Charge target.

- Roll **1D6** and add it to the Unit's **Speed**. This is the Charge Roll

Distance.

- Measure along the actual path of travel - bypass impassable obstacles. Follow **Gap Clearance** rules (Part 4.6).

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3. SUCCESSFUL AND FAILED CHARGES

The **Charge** succeeds only if the **Leading Model** can be legally set in a position that is:

- **Wholly Within** the **Charge Roll Distance** of its starting point.
- **Within** the **Engagement Range** (1") of every declared **Charge** target.
- Not overlapping other **bases** or **impassable terrain**.
- Not **Within** the **Engagement Range** of any **Enemy** Unit that was **not** declared as a target.

If the **Charge** fails, the Unit does not **move**. Its activation ends immediately.

Abathur's TIP: A failed **Charge** means you've wasted your whole activation, so be sure to measure carefully before committing to a **Charge**. The **Charge Roll** is your **Speed** plus 1D6, so be aware of your minimum, average, and maximum ranges. If the target is right at the edge of your maximum range, you may want to consider whether a **Move** or **Run** this Round to close the distance will put you into position for a guaranteed **Charge** into them next Round. When you declare multiple **Charge** targets, remember that the **Leading Model** has to be **Within 1"** of all the targets you've declared to **Charge** at. Multi-charges are powerful but can be very risky - if the targets don't line up just right, you'll have wasted your whole **Charge** and won't hit any of the targets.

4. EXECUTE THE MOVE

Move the **Leading Model** into the valid position. Set it in **Base-to-Base** contact with the **Charge** target(s) if possible - otherwise as close as possible **Within** the **Engagement Range**.

Set remaining **models** **In Coherency** - **Coherency Links** may pass through **Enemy models** the Unit is **Engaged** with (Part 4.4). None may end **Within** the **Engagement Range** of a Unit not declared as a target. Placement priority:

- **Priority A:** **Base-to-Base** contact with declared target **models** (whenever physically possible).
- **Priority B:** **Within** the **Engagement Range** of targets (if **Base-to-Base** is impossible).

- **Priority C:** As close as possible to the Leading Model to maintain **Coherency**.

Visual example multi charge-0 placeholder

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8.8 PHASE 3: THE COMBAT PHASE



There is no room for tactics at arm's length. Psi blades clash with claws, bayonets scrape against carapace, and the only thing that matters is who is still standing when the dust settles. During the Combat Phase, Engaged Units close the distance to their foes and trade blows in brutal melee combat. Unlike the previous Phases, where activation is voluntary, every Unit currently in the Engagement Range of an Enemy must act in this Phase. A player cannot choose to skip a fight.

Flying Units are never Engaged and therefore never participate in the Combat Phase. They cannot be **Activated**, cannot **Close Ranks**, and cannot be the target of **Close Combat Attacks**.

DESIGNER'S NOTE: By making the activation of the **Close Combat Attack** obligatory for all Engaged Units, there is no longer an opportunity to exploit the game by avoiding an unfavourable melee combat. After the Units are in close combat with each other, the combat ensues. This promotes cautious decision-making during the Movement and Assault Phases and prevents any tendency to delay combat in the Combat Phase.

ACTIVATIONS

Players take turns activating one Engaged Unit at a time. The holder of the First Player Marker chooses who activates first. Players then alternate, each activating one Engaged Unit per turn. When an eligible Unit is **Activated**, it follows the **Close Combat Attack** (Part 8.8.1).

UNIT ELIGIBILITY

Only Engaged Units may be **Activated** during this Phase. Unengaged Units cannot act. Once a Unit's **Close Combat Attack** is fully resolved, remove its **Activation Marker**.

PASSING

A player Passes only when they have no remaining Engaged Units to activate. When both players Pass, the Phase ends.

8.9 PHASE 4: THE SCORING & CLEANUP PHASE



Score, cleanup, set initiative.

The first player initiates each step in order:

- Determine **Mission Marker** Control
- Score Victory Points
- End of Game Check
- Resolve **End of the Round** Effects
- Cleanup & Refresh
- Determine Initiative

8.9.1 Determine Mission Marker Control



IDENTIFY CONTESTING UNITS

A Unit may Contest a **Mission Marker** only if all three conditions are met:

- It is on the battlefield (not in Reserves).
- At least one model is Within 3", has **LoS** to the Marker, and is on the same elevation as the marker. For the purpose of tracing **LoS**, assume that the Marker has **Size 0**.
- The Unit is **In Coherency**.

A Flying Unit cannot Contest or Control Mission Markers, regardless of its position or **Coherency** state.

Abathur's TIP: **Mission Marker** is controlled by the total Supply, not by the number of models vying for the Marker. A lone Elite Unit with high Supply will outvote an entire horde of cheap infantry. Hence, placing a high-Supply Unit on the objective can sometimes be a better strategy than scattering weakened Units across it. On the other hand, if your foe is holding a Marker with a single strong Unit, you must have the combined Supply to win the battle, not simply the numbers. It is also worth noting that a Unit at Supply 0 will still hold the Marker if no one contests it,

so a weakened Unit is not necessarily useless.

CALCULATE CONTROL

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For each Marker:

- Each player sums the Current Supply Value of all their contesting Units.
- The player with the **higher** total **Controls** the Marker.
- A **tie** means the Marker is **Contested** - control does not change.
- A Unit at Supply 0 may still Control a Marker if no Enemy Units contest it.

STICKY CONTROL

Set a **Faction Indicator** on each controlled Marker. Once a Marker is controlled, it remains under that player's control - even if they move Units away - until the opponent actively reclaims it by ending a Scoring Phase with a higher contesting Supply total. A **Contested** result (tied Supply) **never** transfers control: the Marker stays with whoever currently holds it, or remains neutral if it has never been controlled. A Marker **cannot** become neutral again once a player has taken control of it.

DESIGNER'S NOTE: Sticky Control means that a location becomes yours until the opponent re-takes it from you. This prevents the irritating problem in some wargames where you grab a location, push forward to grab another, and the first location reverts to no one in particular. It encourages bold play, taking what you want and holding it, and moving forward to take more. It creates a real strategic challenge, too, because taking a Marker forces the opponent to use real resources to take the objective rather than just waiting for you to leave.

MISSION MARKER - CALCULATING CONTROL

Scenario	Outcome	Notes
HOW CONTROL IS DECIDED (<u>\$8.9.1</u>)		
Player A Supply > Player B Supply	✓ PLAYER A CONTROLS	Sum <u>Current Supply Value</u> of all eligible contesting <u>Units</u> - not model count.

Player A Supply =
Player B Supply

◆ CONTESTED

No change of control. Stays with current owner (or neutral never held).

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Only one player
contests

✓ THAT PLAYER
CONTROLS

Includes the case where the only
contesting Unit is at Supply 0.

No player contests

• NO CHANGE

Sticky Control - Marker stays
with the current owner until
actively reclaimed.

STICKY CONTROL (§8.9.1)

Controlled Marker -
owner moves away

✓ STAYS
CONTROLLED

Control is only lost if the
opponent ends a Scoring Phase
with a higher Supply total.

Contested result
(tied Supply)

◆ NO
TRANSFER

Tied Supply never transfers
control. Current owner keeps it.

Once controlled -
can it revert to
neutral?

✗ NEVER
NEUTRAL AGAIN

Once a player has taken control,
the Marker cannot become neutral
again.

MARKER AFFINITY (§9.2.1)

Markers 1 & 3

• RED PLAYER

Affinity is set after the draft
is complete.

Markers 2 & 4

• BLUE PLAYER

Affinity is set after the draft
is complete.

Marker 5

- NEUTRAL

No player affinity.

KEY RULE: Control is determined by **Current Supply Value**, not the number of **models**. A single high-Supply Elite Unit outvotes many low-Supply **models** on the same Marker.

MISSION MARKER - CONTESTING ELIGIBILITY

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Condition	Required?	Detail
ELIGIBILITY TO CONTEST - ALL THREE MUST BE MET (§8.9.1)		
Unit on the battlefield	✓ REQUIRED	<u>Units</u> in <u>Reserves</u> cannot contest.
At least one model <u>Within</u> 3" of the Marker has LoS, on the same elevation	✓ REQUIRED	Measured from base edge. LoS and elevation checks are both required.
Unit is In Coherency	✓ REQUIRED	<u>Out of Coherency Units</u> cannot contest or control any Marker.
SPECIAL STATES		
Supply 0 Unit	◆ CONDITIONAL	Can control a Marker if no <u>Enemy Units</u> contest it. Cannot win a contest.
<u>BURROWED</u> Unit	✗ CANNOT CONTEST	Overrides standard contesting rules regardless of position. (<u>BURROWED</u>)
<u>Out of Coherency</u> Unit	✗ CANNOT CONTEST	Ineligible even if <u>models</u> are <u>Within</u> 3".
<u>Flying</u> Unit	✗ CANNOT CONTEST	Airborne <u>Units</u> do not <u>hold</u> ground. Overrides standard contesting rules regardless of position. (<u>Flying</u>)

8.9.2 Score Victory Points

Both players simultaneously tally **VPs** based on the **Mission Card's** scoring conditions.

8.9.3 End of Game Check

The game ends immediately if:

- A **Special Winning Condition** is fulfilled. The player who meets it wins outright.
- A player has no models on the battlefield and no Units in Reserves. The surviving player gains **+10 VP**.
- The final Phase of the final Round (usually Round 5) is complete - proceed to Part 8.10.

8.9.4 Resolve End of the Round Effects

Resolve all "**End of the Round**" abilities. The holder of the First Player Marker resolves their first.

If a player has multiple "**End of the Round**" effects to resolve, that player chooses the order in which their effects resolve. Each effect is fully resolved before the next begins.

8.9.5 Cleanup & Refresh

- Remove all Tokens and Markers except:
- Tokens and Markers with STAY IN PLAY.
- Damage Markers.
- Mission Markers.
- **Faction Indicators** that represent **Control** over Mission Markers.

- Flip all **Exhausted** Tactical and **Faction Cards** back to their active (face

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8.9.6 Determine Initiative

- Award the First Player Marker to the player with **fewer** Victory Points.
- If tied, conduct a Roll-Off. The winner takes the First Player Marker.
- Begin Phase 1 of the next Round.

DESIGNER'S NOTE: The choice of initiative going to the player with fewer Victory Points is a "catch-up" mechanic. The player behind goes first in the next Round, giving them a chance to reposition and compete for objectives before the leading player can secure their position. This prevents a runaway lead where the player who starts ahead always remains ahead by an ever-widening gap. When the Passing mechanic is included (where the first player to **Pass** gets the First Player Marker for the next Phase), initiative is no longer a static advantage but a fluid resource.

8.10 THE FINAL SCORE

When the last round is fired, and silence falls, the final victory hinges on territory gained and lives lost. Every objective taken, every Enemy line crossed, every soldier kept in reserve - all details contribute to deciding the day's victor. The battlefield tells a story, but the scoreboard tells who wrote it.

If the game ends by the Round Limit:

- **Mission Score:** Total all **VP** earned from objectives.